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The economy of Hausa communities of Zaria

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Joking relations can appropriate small items of one another's property, [unavailable] will refer to each other by the terms denoting "husband" or "wife", or at her times as "slave" or "master"; a grandfather may call his granddaughter [unavailable] wife", while the grandmother may join in and call the little girl "my [unavailable] wife" ([kishiarta](#)); cross-cousins often make play with the allusion to [unavailable] and slave mentioned above - "the brother's son is the slave of the sister's son". This superiority-inferiority element of master and slave in [unavailable] relationships suggests that they may have the function of relieving the [unavailable] inherent in certain dominance situations, such as those of [unavailable], who are potential spouses under the Hausa preferred marriage, often forced against their wishes. If this marriage takes place, the joking relationship normally comes to an end. The joking relations centred about a married people serve to relieve the tensions which are expressed in the [unavailable] ([suruki](#)) relationships holding between most of the parties concerned.

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Shame-avoidance relationships all centre on marriage, the [unavailable] ([dan fari](#)) avoidance being the latest to be created by the situation. [unavailable] is a difference of status between the groups brought into relationship [unavailable] one another by a marriage, and the behaviour pattern serves to reduce [unavailable] by employing a different mechanism to that of the joking relationships. In the marital situation, the wife's kin enjoy a superior[unavailable] to the husband's kin, whereas the husband regards himself as his wife's [unavailable], she being a legal minor.

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Finally, fondness relationships are the usual basis for adoption. In [unavailable] to those already mentioned, based on kinship, both men and women [unavailable] will sometimes adopt one another's children; this occurs more [unavailable] among kawaye (sing. kawa), women who have entered into a formal bond friendship, than between abokai (sing. aboki, friend, but particularly ban aboki, chief friend), men friends, who more often arrange marriages between their children. The fondness and protective feeling between elder daughter and younger brother (ya and kane) is based on the conflict of two of [unavailable] determinants of the kinship system - seniority by birth and [unavailable] by sex; this is enhanced where the sister was old enough to be [unavailable] with the care of her baby brother - "ta goye shi" as the Hausa say, [unavailable] carried him about on her back". Elder brother and younger sister have this close link, but a woman's wa will assist her, and after her father's  46 death will act as her guardian. Where no difference of sex modifies the principle of age seniority, elder and younger brother (wa and kane) stand in a relationship of discipline and respect to one another, depending on the difference in their ages for its relative strength. The father's elder sister is the children's favourite aunt (gogo) according to the ideal pattern, and she often adopts one of the children. Marriage of her children and her younger brother's children is the most preferred cross-cousin marriage - "auren dan mace da dan kane", the marriage of a woman's child with her younger brother's child - and these cross-cousins display the strongest joking relationship.

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